

--- layout: brief title: "Brief: Huntress - Principal Software Engineer, SOC Experience" description: "Tailored 1-page executive pitch brief for Principal Software Engineer, SOC Experience (Ruby/Rails) at Huntress." permalink: /exports/briefs/huntress-principal-software-engineer-soc-experience-ruby-rails/ breadcrumb: "Huntress Brief" breadcrumb_parent_name: Exports breadcrumb_parent_url: /exports/ brief_company: "Huntress" brief_role: "Principal Software Engineer, SOC Experience (Ruby/Rails)" sitemap: false robots: noindex,nofollow body_class: ats-resume ---

Candidate: Mike Hall (Just3Ws) **Target Role:** Principal Software Engineer, SOC Experience (Ruby/Rails) **Company:** Huntress (Remote, US) **Core Domain:** High-Concurrency Ruby on Rails Architecture, SOC Telemetry, Distributed Systems, Legacy De-risking

--- ## Executive Summary & Mandate Alignment Huntress's mission: "scaling high-concurrency Ruby on Rails platforms that power 24/7 Security Operations Center (SOC) detection, investigation, and incident response": matches my track record stabilizing high-consequence monoliths, deploying distributed OpenTelemetry, and isolating critical failure modes under live load. I bring calm, deterministic systems leadership to teams where platform reliability directly impacts threat detection and security operations.

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1. High-Consequence Rails Monolith Architecture & Modernization

- Acquisition Lane Architecture (OneMain Financial):** Appointed Software Architect for an acquisition engine processing hundreds of millions in financial throughput. Mapped seven heterogeneous ingress channels, refactored multi-step Rails state machines, and decoupled service boundaries between Acquisition and Originations.
- Database Archaeology & Safety:** Architected an automated 5-phase PII remediation deletion engine across 30+ tables, safely purging legacy orphan records under production traffic without table locks.
- Craftsmanship Foundations:** Production Ruby on Rails expertise (2.x through 8.x), strict TDD discipline, and relational data modeling in PostgreSQL.

2. Deep Observability, Distributed Tracing & Incident Command

- Enterprise Trace Deployment:** Led the enterprise OpenTelemetry deployment across distributed Rails services, MuleSoft APIs, and Mainframe backends. Standardized W3C trace context headers to bridge siloed logs into causal event chains.
- Eliminating Silent Outages:** Diagnosed and eliminated a persistent CookieOverflow defect that silently dropped 4% of digital loan applications during offer selection and e-signing, implementing custom rescue middleware and migrating Rails session storage to AWS DynamoDB.
- Community Enablement:** Founded Geekfest@OMF and the weekly OpenTelemetry Working Group, scaling cross-lane participation to 40+ engineers before transitioning ongoing facilitation sustainably to SRE.

3. Cyber & Fraud Detection Systems

- Fraud & Anomaly Analytics (Groupon):** Designed analytical fraud detection queries in Vertica, analyzed merchant transaction risk, and conducted exploratory anomaly detection spikes in Hadoop and Clojure.
- Edge Telemetry & Scrubbing (Agent Tooling / www.workremote):** Built OTel telemetry ingestion pipelines with automated PII-scrubbing at the collector edge, enabling safe root-cause diagnosis for security investigations.

--- ## — 30-Second Interview Calibration (The "Answer, Frame, and Pause" Rule)

> "I specialize in high-consequence Ruby on Rails platforms where uptime, data integrity, and deep observability are non-negotiable. At OneMain Financial, I led the Acquisition architecture: mapping seven ingress channels, eliminating a 4% silent traffic drop via DynamoDB session remediation, and safely purging legacy PII across 30+ database tables. Huntress protects organizations against real-world adversaries, and I bring the platform resilience and telemetry discipline required to keep SOC analysts fast and systems unbreakable."

> > (Pause & Hook): "I can dive deeper into how we migrated Rails session storage to DynamoDB, or we can look at the 5-phase database deletion engine. Which direction would you prefer to explore?"

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— Authoritative Verification Links

- System Cartography Essay:** just3ws.com/2026/08/29/system-cartography-how-to-map-a-ten-year-old-monolith/
- Portfolio & Case Studies:** just3ws.com/case-studies/
- Canonical Résumé:** just3ws.com/resume
- GitHub Profile:** github.com/just3ws